

A Thousand Tiny Hands

Little Wonderer opened a strap on a shoe,
and it went RRRIP! like a grumpy kazoo.
"Who's hiding in there?" asked the small one, aghast.
"A thousand tiny hands," said the big one, "holding fast."

One side is all hooks, like a crowd of bent canes,
or umbrellas turned upside down, left out in the rains.
The other side's loops, like a soft curly mat,
and the hooks grab the loops, and that's simply that.

Big Wonderer said, "Slide them sideways — they'll hold,
every hook pulling hard, all together and bold.
But peel from a corner, a few at a time,
and they let go as easy as saying this rhyme."

Who dreamed it up first? Not a wizard or king,
but a burr on a dog, such a scratchy small thing.
So the little one bowed to a burr on its stem:
"Thank you for holding on. We learned it from them."